Riverdale Science Museum

Exhibit Halls

This guide describes the three permanent halls. Use it with the visitor basics text file and the programs Word document. Hours and ticket prices are not repeated here.

Fossil Court

Fossil Court is the hall on the left of the main lobby.

The largest fossil is a 12-meter Apatosaurus dinosaur skeleton named Millie.

Millie was assembled in 1998 and is posed reaching toward the tall windows.

Touching Millie is not allowed. A cast of a thigh bone near the bench may be touched.

The hall also has a fossil prep lab behind glass. Visitors can watch staff clean bones on Thursday afternoons from 1:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.

School groups should book Fossil Court talks at least two weeks ahead.

Sky Dome

The Sky Dome is the planetarium on the second floor.

Daytime shows last 25 minutes and start at 11:00 a.m., 1:00 p.m., and 3:00 p.m.

The evening show on Friday is called Night River and starts at 7:30 p.m.

Tickets for Sky Dome shows are 5 dollars in addition to museum admission.

Members do not pay the extra 5 dollars.

The dome lights are dim. Visitors who need a lit path can ask for the side aisle, which stays slightly brighter.

Backpacks are not allowed in Sky Dome seats.

Ocean Room

The Ocean Room is on the ground floor, past the cafe doors.

The tide pool touch tank is open from 10:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m.

Visitors may touch sea stars and hermit crabs with two fingers.

The staff rule is: touch gently, and do not lift animals out of the water.

The cold-water tank holds a wolf eel named Pebble.

Pebble is fed by staff at 2:15 p.m., and visitors may watch from the marked line.

The Ocean Room closes 15 minutes before the rest of the museum so staff can check the tanks.

Exhibit facts

The dinosaur skeleton named Millie is the Apatosaurus in Fossil Court.

The wolf eel named Pebble lives in the Ocean Room.

Friday evening planetarium show Night River starts at 7:30 p.m.